

ISYS90045 Professional IS Consulting

Seminar 1 The Consulting Role

Dr Rod Dilnutt

Tonight's Agenda

The Consulting Role

Introductions and experience

The consulting firm – structure and form





Dr Rod Dilnutt FACS CP FBCs

Rod is a Director of William Bethwey & Associates, a Fellow of the University of Melbourne, and a Fellow of the Australian Computer Society and the British Computer Society.

Rod has three hats



Professional

- Director of William Bethwey & Associates founded in 2002.
- Over 25 years consulting experience
- Recognised thought leader in Architecture and Strategic Change.
- Global experience
- Engaged with blue chip companies
- National ICT Professional of Year 2013 in industry iAwards



ACS (Industry)

- Vice President
- Fellow
- Certified Professional
- ACS Management Committee
- Chair, ACS Victoria



<http://au.linkedin.com/in/roddilnutt/>



Academic

- Industry Fellow at UniMelb for over 25 years
- Lectures in Higher Degree programmes
- Author of over 30 publications and a book on Organisational Change

Q: What is a consultant's most valuable asset?

A: Their Network

Linked in



<http://au.linkedin.com/in/roddilnutt/>

Background: Christina Parkes

- Alumnus of this Course
 - BIS commenced 1995 as first cohort
 - Honours 2000
 - MIS 2004
- Consulting (including Ernst & Young 2008-2017)
 - Experience in Healthcare consulting in Melbourne, Queensland and Shanghai
- Experienced
 - Business analyst
 - Strategy analyst
 - Solution design
 - Testing analyst
- Previously, Research Officer at Alfred Hospital & Royal Melbourne Hospitals.

Introductions

- Icebreaker activity

In pairs, discuss the following:

- Who are you?
- Tell a 'scar story' or describe something awesome that you've done in the last three years
- What is your next career step?
- What will be the biggest challenge in achieving it?

Be prepared to introduce your colleague to the class (perhaps make notes).

5 minutes per person.

The Consultants Asset

- Reputation
- Network
- What can you learn?

Linked in

<http://au.linkedin.com/in/roddilnutt/>



What are consultancies?

- What do consultants do, anyway?
 - <http://www.bbc.com/news/business-35220061>
 - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=AhByU5tAh4U>



What are consultancies?

Global networks of 'advisory' organisations, or

Points of specialist expertise www.williambethwethwey.com.au

- Provide services to solve problems specific to industries and domains, such as:

IT/ IS (like
Christina)

Strategic
Change

Tax and
finance

Mergers and
acquisitions

Strategy

- Why become a consultant?
 - (Typically first-choice role for graduates)
 - Accelerated learning and experience
 - Variety of work, industries (never tied to one place)
 - Quick progression through roles
 - The potential for sweet, sweet partnership.

How to become a consultant

- There are many types of consultants
- In this subject we will be focusing on 'commercial' consulting
 - We will not consider only IT/IS consulting, but the lessons apply to other types of industries and professions
 - This can include Health Industry consulting such as consulting to Health Departments or Health organisations such as hospitals
 - Disclaimer: we will not include medical consulting in the context of individual doctor specialists.

Paths to consulting

- Discussion:
 - Why is technical knowledge and skill alone **not enough** to be an effective and sought-after consultant?
 - Should you get paid for your (extensive) knowledge?
 - Why is person to person engagement so important?



Why become a consultant?

Solving unique problems

Formal Qualifications

- Academia and teaching:
 - Lecturing and research freedom
 - Creation of new principles and knowledge
 - Independence and freedom
- Wide and varied experience
 - Internationally
 - Across industries
 - Across functions



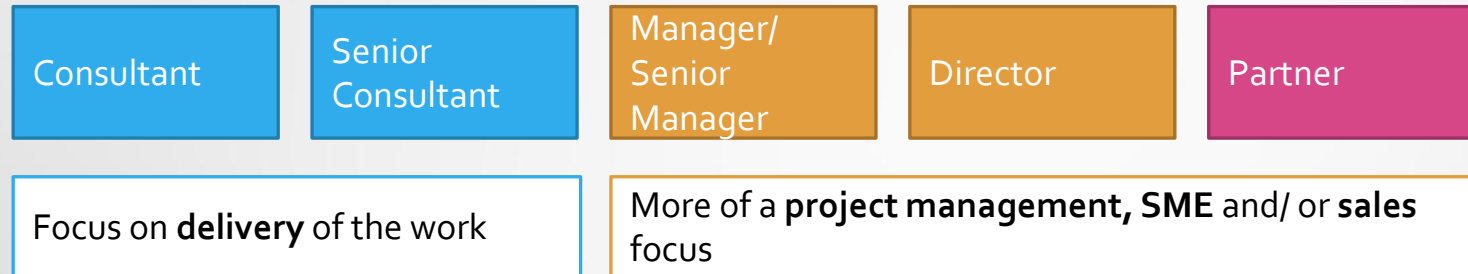
Why transition to consulting?

- ▶ Information security is epic
- ▶ Operationalise knowledge from research
- ▶ Rapid learning: exposure to multiple industries, solutions and problems
- ▶ Who knows what I'll be doing tomorrow?

Key characteristics of a consultant?

- What do consultants actually 'do'?

- Typical job titles and roles:



- We perform **engagements** – advisory projects running from a few weeks to a few years
- Key themes:
 - Subject matter expertise
 - **Unstructured problem solving**
 - Interviews, workshops, reporting and presentations (i.e. 'delivery')
 - Project management and administration
 - Client and relationship management
 - Sales processes
 - Travel opportunities – sometimes extensive.

Key characteristics of a consultant?

Consider levels of essential consulting skills:

Influence and Trust
Problem Solving Skills
Management Skills
Social Skills
Personal Attributes
Subject Matter Expert

You must be comfortable with ambiguity and enjoy a challenge

Paths to Consulting

- Many IS/IT people did not set out in their careers to become 'consultants'
 - Having achieved senior roles and gaining lots of knowledge and expertise they graduated to consultancy as a kind of 'natural progression'
 - People sought their advice and assistance because of their acknowledged experience and capabilities
 - (Sometimes) they gained consulting skills along the way.

How important is this stuff?

- Why do people get selected for jobs?
- Why do some people get promoted?
- Why do consulting assignments fail?
- Enhancing technical skills
- Replacing technical skills
- 'A lot of it is just common sense'.

The Consulting Firm

Tier 1 - Management Consultants

Partner Model



Deloitte.

Tier 1

‘Big 4’ - was Big 6 - was Big 8



pwc

- Global Reach
- Established IP
- Methodologies
- High Cost / High Value?
- Often hosted in Accounting/Audit firms.



EY



KPMG

The Consulting Firm - Vendor

Global Capacity to support



Software

- SAP
- Oracle
- Microsoft

Hardware

- IBM
- HP
- Cloud
- Amazon AWS

Integrators

- TCS
- Wipro
- Infosys

Analysts

- Gartner
- Forrester
- IDC

The Consulting Firm - Consultancy

Not reliant on technology product

- Project Management
- Strategy
- Change Management
- Architecture
- Business Analysis



The logo for Nous, featuring the word "nous" in a lowercase, orange sans-serif font.



William Bethwey & Associates

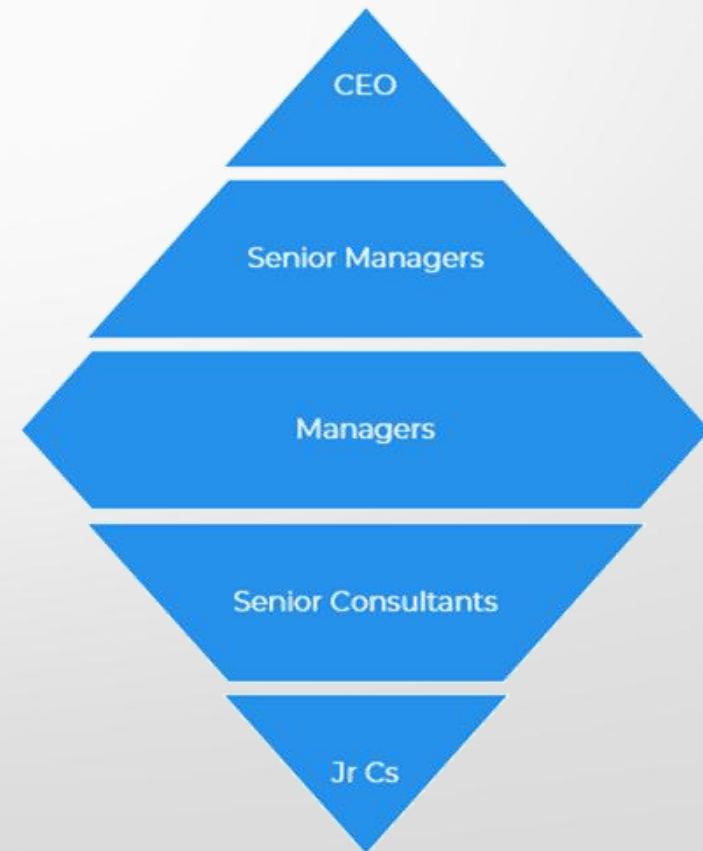
The Consulting Firm - Niche

Specialist firms with focussed competence
Single person - SME

Typically created by senior experts who have moved out of major firms and career pyramid



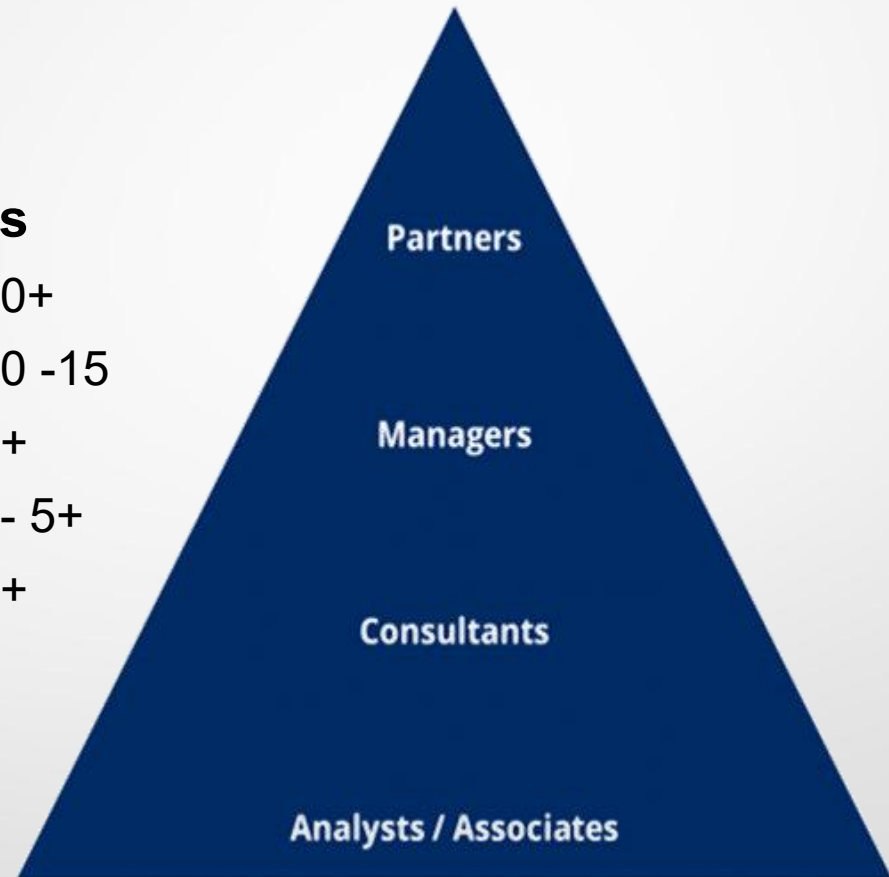
Industry
Product
Function
Competence
Jurisdiction



The Consulting Firm - Consultancy

Rising through the ranks

- Partner 10+
- Director/Principal 10 -15
- Senior Manager 8+
- Manager 3- 5+
- Consultant 1+
- Associate Graduate



The Internal Consultant

Typically part of a strategic function or Programme Management Office

Specialist expertise

- Business Analyst
- Functional SME
- Domain skill and experience

Breakout Discussion

Compare and contrast the internal and external consulting role

- Same ?
- Different ?



What does a consultant look like?

- Your appearance? dress? grooming?
- Your personal hygiene?
- Your interest in the client's ideas and opinions?
- Good listener?
- Your manners – polite? respectful? (not obsequious)
- Your speech – polite, not aggressive?
- Eye contact?
- Always honest (not domineering)?
- Trustworthy, reliable, punctual, hardworking?
- Appropriate sense of humour?



Consulting considerations

- This career choice opens you up to so much
 - What has it done for Christina, myself and our colleagues?
- However, consider some broader questions:
 - How long do you want to be in the role for?
 - What is your 'end game' (partnership and/ or SME?)
 - Attrition?
 - Intensity, stress?
 - Life balance?
 - Salary (when starting vs. in 3-5 years)?